EquWord Quick Start for Windows

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Software distribution version 1.0.0

Document revision 1.0.0

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Instructions prepared for Microsoft Word for Windows

Word 16.0.20430.20180 64 bit

Windows 11 Home build 26300

Repository https://github.com/PsycheMatrica/EquWord

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This guide covers Windows installation, manuscript setup, ribbon buttons, and first use. Mac users should open EquWord_Quick_Start_Mac.pdf.

The screenshots were captured with Research Equation Formatter 0.9.27. They illustrate the Windows controls retained for EquWord 1.0.0; menu wording can vary by Word build.

Use this guide to load the Word template, prepare a manuscript, add convenient ribbon buttons, and format your first equations. Your manuscript remains a .docx file and its equations remain editable. Keep ResearchEquationFormatter.dotm in a permanent folder and work on a copy of your document.

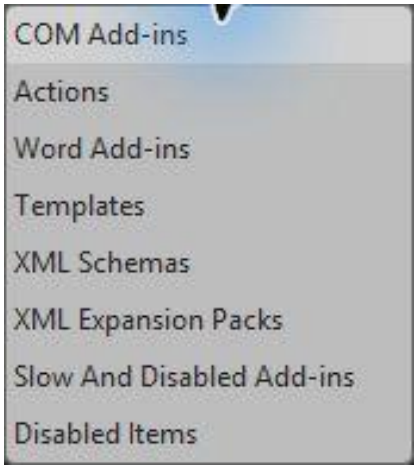
Open the Word Template Settings

1. Extract the distribution ZIP. Use desktop Microsoft Word for Windows; Word for the web cannot run the template.

2. In Word, choose File > Options > Add-ins. At the bottom, set Manage to Word Add-ins and select Go. See Figure 1.

Figure 1

Choose Word Add-ins in the Manage List



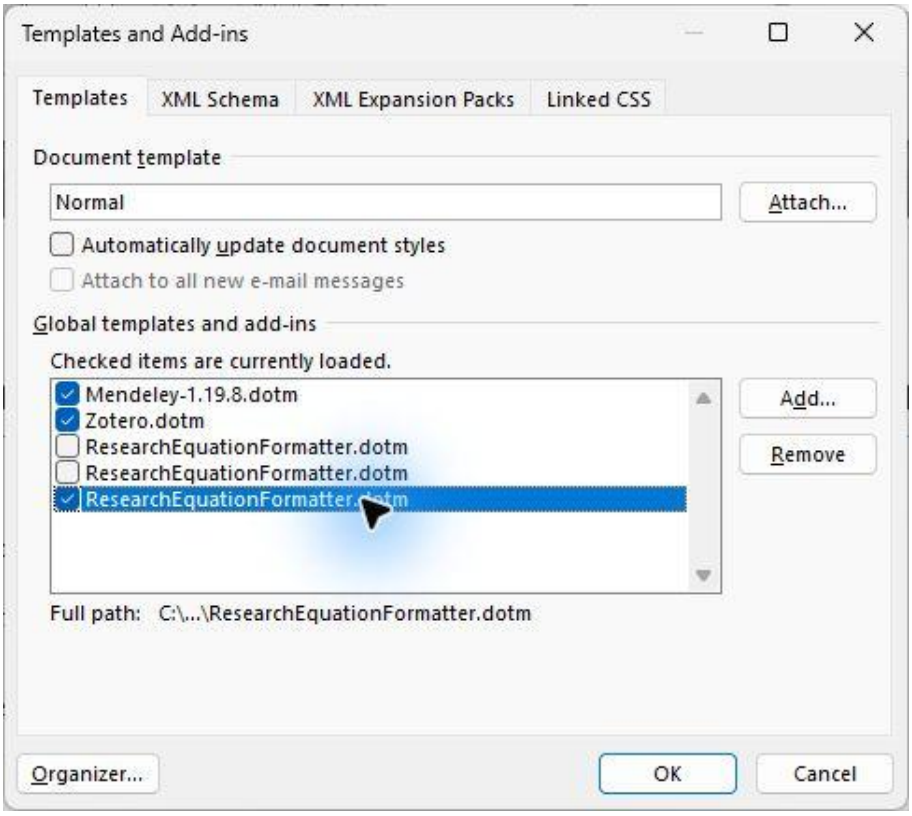
You do not need to import .bas, .cls or UserForm files. The template already contains the VBA project. If your organization blocks macros, follow its policy. Do not enable all macros or change VBA-project access settings for this tool.

Load the Template and Check the Version

3. In Templates, select Add. Locate ResearchEquationFormatter.dotm, open it, and leave its checkbox selected. Clear any older edition to avoid duplicate commands, then select OK. See Figure 2.

Figure 2

The Selected Formatter Template in Global Templates and Add-ins



4. Press Alt+F8, select AboutResearchEquationFormatter and choose Run. Confirm version 1.0.0 and the CC BY-NC-SA 4.0 license.

This method loads the template for the current Word session. Load it again after restarting Word. For automatic loading, find Word's Startup folder under File > Options > Advanced > General > File Locations and place the template there. Your manuscript does not need to be saved as .docm.

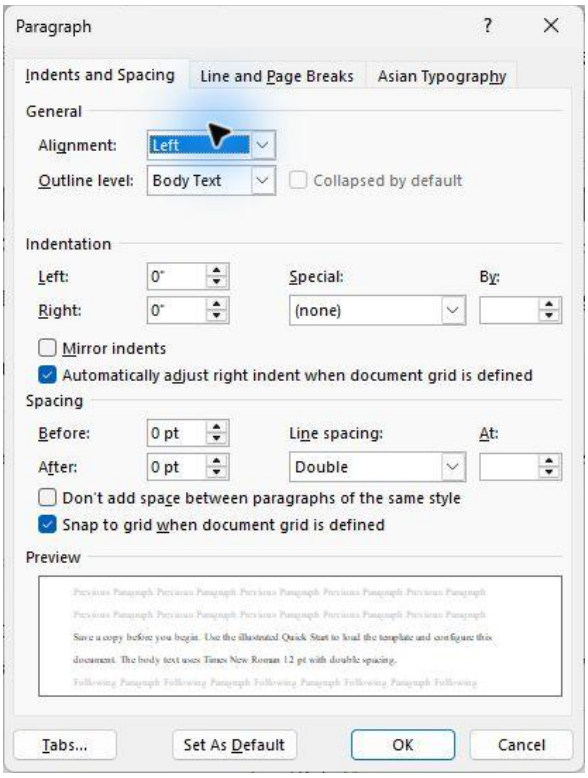
Prepare a Working Document

5. Save a manuscript working copy as Word Document (.docx). To follow the exercises, open REF_Practice.docx and save a separate copy.

6. Set the required body paragraph spacing first. For example, choose Home > Paragraph dialog launcher > Indents and Spacing > Double. Apply this to the body style or ordinary body paragraphs, not only to an equation. See Figure 3.

Figure 3

Double Line Spacing for the Manuscript Body



7. Turn Track Changes off before running the formatter. Existing revisions are not accepted automatically. Work in the main document body; headers, footnotes, endnotes and text boxes are outside these commands' scope.

Equation paragraphs follow body spacing. Merged equation arrays have a separate internal-row setting, so a Double-spaced body and 1.5-line merged rows can be used together. There is no extra bottom-spacing option.

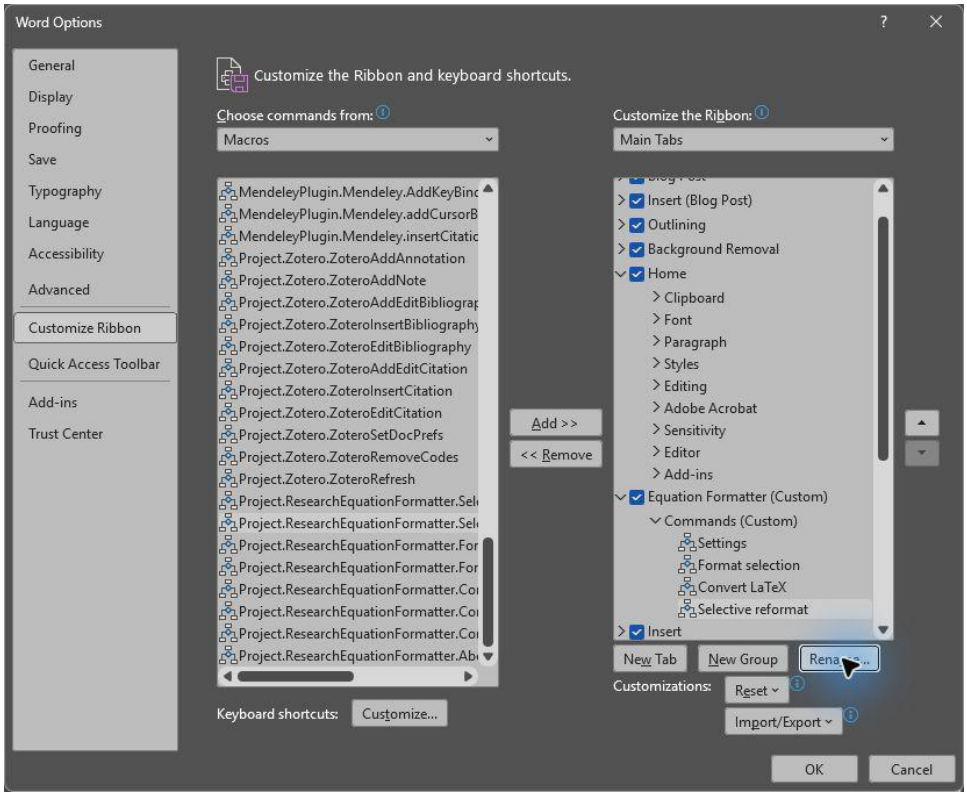
Add Convenient Ribbon Buttons

8. Choose File > Options > Customize Ribbon. Set Choose commands from to Macros. In the right-hand list, select New Tab and rename it Equation Formatter. Rename its custom group Commands.

9. Select a formatter macro in the left list, select the custom group on the right, and choose Add. Use Rename to give the button a short label. The macro list may include a project or module prefix; identify each command by the final name below. See Figure 4.

Figure 4

The Equation Formatter Tab Prepared in Word Options



- ConfigureCurrentDocument — Settings
- FormatEquationsInSelection — Format selection
- ConvertAndFormatLatexInSelection — Convert LaTeX

- SelectiveReformatInSelection — Selective reformat

10. Select OK to apply your ribbon layout. You can also add the three whole-document commands and AboutResearchEquationFormatter. Ribbon customization belongs to this Word installation; the formatting profile belongs to the current .docx file.

Ribbon buttons are optional. Alt+F8 can run the same commands whenever the template is loaded.

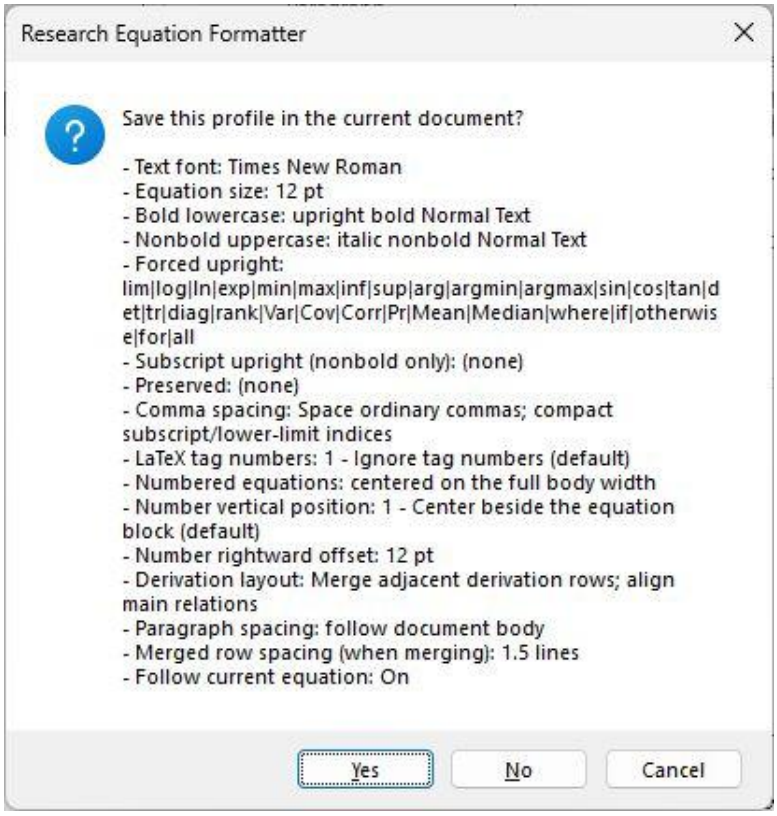
Save Settings for This Manuscript

11. Activate the manuscript or practice document you want to format. Run ConfigureCurrentDocument, using your Settings button or Alt+F8. Review the prompts and final summary, choose Yes to save the profile, then save the .docx file.

For a first test, keep Times New Roman at 12 pt. Choose option 2 for merging, then option 2 for 1.5-line merged rows. Keep the default 12 pt number offset. Existing document profiles retain their earlier choices, so recheck them when updating the template. See Figure 5.

Figure 5

Document Settings to Review Before Formatting



Follow current equation controls whether Word displays the equation being processed. It is separate from the formatting categories. AboutResearchEquationFormatter shows the settings currently stored in the active document.

These settings govern typography and layout. The formatter does not check whether an equation is mathematically correct.

Run the First Examples

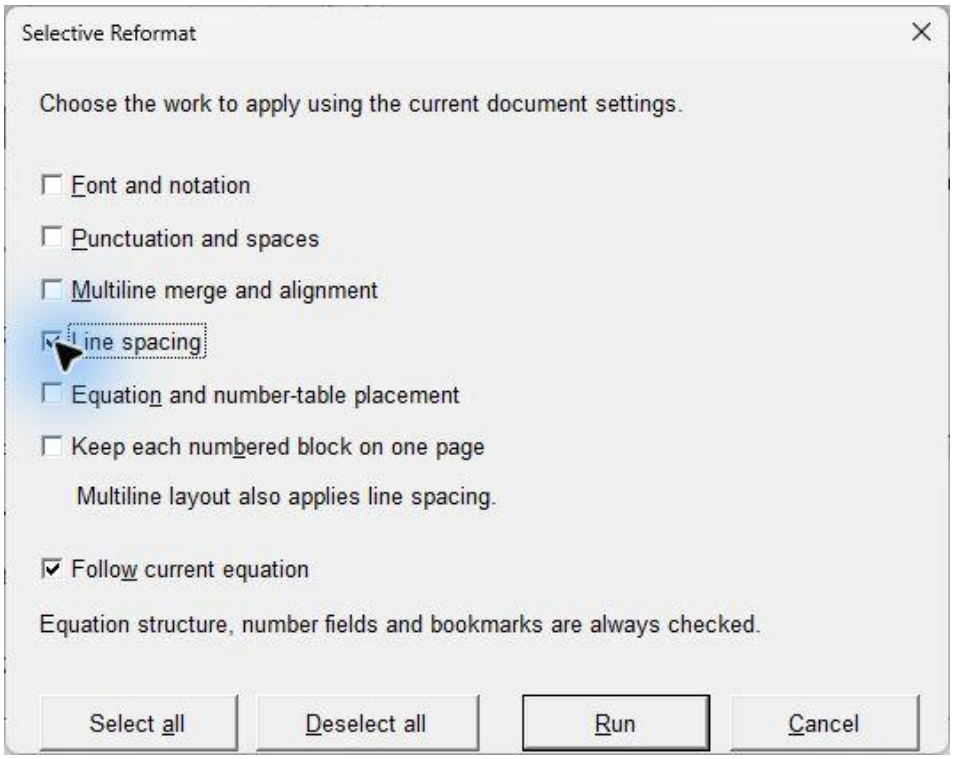
12. In Exercise 1 of REF_Practice.docx, select the complete literal LaTeX expression, including its delimiters, and run ConvertAndFormatLatexInSelection. For the native Word equation in Exercise 2, use FormatEquationsInSelection instead.

13. In Exercise 3, select both adjacent equation paragraphs inside the left table cell and run FormatEquationsInSelection. A cursor placed in only one row requests single-equation processing and will not select the whole group for merging.

14. To apply only part of the formatting, run SelectiveReformatInSelection. Deselect all, choose the categories you need, and select Run. The last accepted category choices are remembered. Follow current equation remains independent. See Figure 6.

Figure 6

Selected Categories in Selective Reformat



Line spacing and equation-number table placement can be selected independently. Multiline merge and alignment also applies line spacing. Equation-structure, number-field and bookmark preservation checks always run, regardless of the selected categories.

Review and Save the Result

15. Read the result dialog and any review notes. Check the equations and neighboring prose, equation numbers and cross-references, multiline alignment, and page breaks. Save the working copy once you are satisfied.

During a run, Word's caption reports the current task and elapsed time. On Windows, Esc requests a stop at the next safe checkpoint. A current Word operation may delay cancellation. Completed edits remain, so review the working copy before saving.

If a block is retained for manual review, inspect the reported reason. After editing a group, select the complete group again when you want to remerge it. Use whole-document commands only when you intend to process the entire main body.

Command Reference

Table 1

Formatter Commands and Their Uses

Command	When to use it
ConfigureCurrentDocument	Set or update the current manuscript profile.
FormatEquationsInSelection	Format selected native equations, or one at the cursor.
FormatAllEquations	Format native equations throughout the main body.
ConvertAndFormatLatexInSelection	Convert supported selected literal LaTeX and format it.
ConvertAndFormatAllLatex	Convert supported literal LaTeX and format the main body.
SelectiveReformatInSelection	Choose categories for selected native equations.
SelectiveReformatAllEquations	Choose categories throughout the main body.
AboutResearchEquationFormatter	Show the loaded version and active document settings.

This guide describes desktop Word for Windows. For Mac installation and command access, use the separate EquWord Quick Start for Mac. Word for the web cannot execute VBA macros.

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Citing EquWord

If EquWord contributed to equation preparation in your manuscript, please consider citing the software in the Acknowledgments or another appropriate section. Cite the version you actually used.

Citation is optional when using EquWord.

Use only statements that reflect your actual use. Adjust the tools, tasks, software version, and singular or plural author wording as needed.

Example of software use

Equations were prepared in Microsoft Word using EquWord (Version 1.0.0; Cho, 2026).

Optional example involving ChatGPT

Use this combined example only if you also used ChatGPT for drafting and revision.

ChatGPT (OpenAI) assisted with drafting and revision. The authors reviewed the AI-assisted content and take responsibility for the final manuscript. Equations were prepared in Microsoft Word using EquWord (Version 1.0.0; Cho, 2026).

Reference

Cho, G. (2026). *EquWord: Equation conversion and formatting for Microsoft Word* (Version 1.0.0) [Computer software]. https://github.com/PsycheMatrica/EquWord

Use the released version's DOI when available.